



INDABAX MAURITANIA 2026 HACKATHON · THEME « POPULATION & DEMOGRAPHY »

Educate where childhood *demand's* the State.

Who are the 375 566 Mauritanian children aged 6-14 out of formal school? Where do they live? What excludes them? This report turns the EPCV 2019 survey into territorialised investment priorities: from percentages to children, from children to decisions.

33,1 %

of 6-14 year-olds out of formal school

72,1 %

of exclusion in 5 wilayas

2030

horizon of the investment scenarios

SOURCES: EPCV 2019 (ONS) · ONS/UNFPA 2022 PROJECTIONS · WORLD BANK WDI · OSM · MLN · DATA.GOV.MR

01 Executive summary

Mauritania is a young country: **4,37 millions** inhabitants, including **1 135 657 Children aged 6-14** (26%). Among them, **375 566 Out of formal school** i.e. 33.1%. Half of these children attend a mahadra (traditional or Quranic); the other half has **No instruction**. The formal system thus absorbs only one child in two of the school-age generation.

4 372 038

POPULATION 2022

1 135 657

CHILDREN AGED 6-14

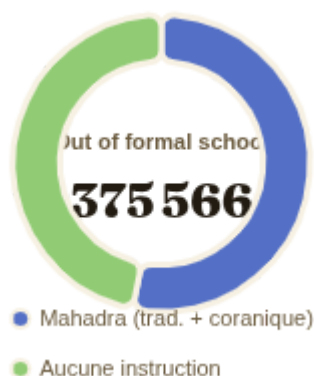
375 566

OUT OF FORMAL SCHOOL

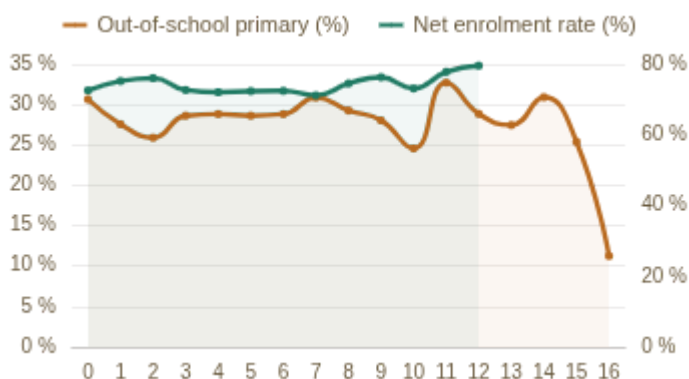
199 493

IN MAHADRA (TRAD. + QURANIC)

BREAKDOWN OF THE EXCLUDED



NATIONAL DECLINE IN OUT-OF-SCHOOL PRIMARY



Three key messages

M1 Exclusion is geographic, not gendered.

Girls and boys are at parity (32% vs 34%). Yet rural doubles urban (42% vs 21%) and 5 wilayas concentrate 72% of the problem.

M2 Age 6-9 is the entry point.

44% of 6-9 year-olds are already out of school versus 23% of 10-14 year-olds: failure is decided at entry into schooling, not at exit.

M3 The mahadra is a bridge, not a dead end.

Half of the excluded are schooled outside formal school. Converting this pool is the most cost-effective lever by 2030 (-39% of out-of-school children by converting 50%).

P1 Hodh El Gharbi

IPE 92,2 maximum priority: mass effort, high volume and rate.

P2 Hodh Ech Chargui

IPE 86,7 the country's leading mahadra pool (48 740 children).

P3 Assaba

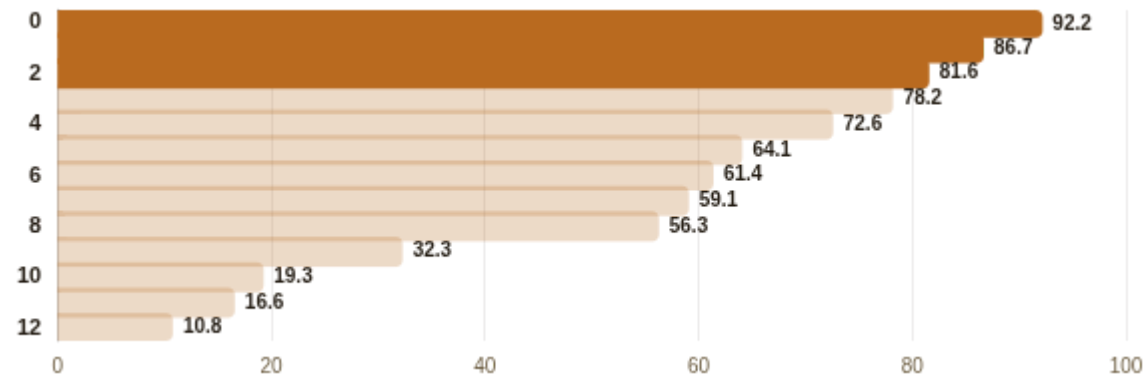
IPE 81,6 third priority, mixed mahadra + no-instruction profile.

02 Ranking: Educational Priority Index (IPE)

IPE = 40% × volume (log of out-of-school children) + 35% × intensity (out-of-school rate) + 25% × vulnerability (75% poverty + 25% youth dependency). Each wilaya is associated with a dominant action lever.

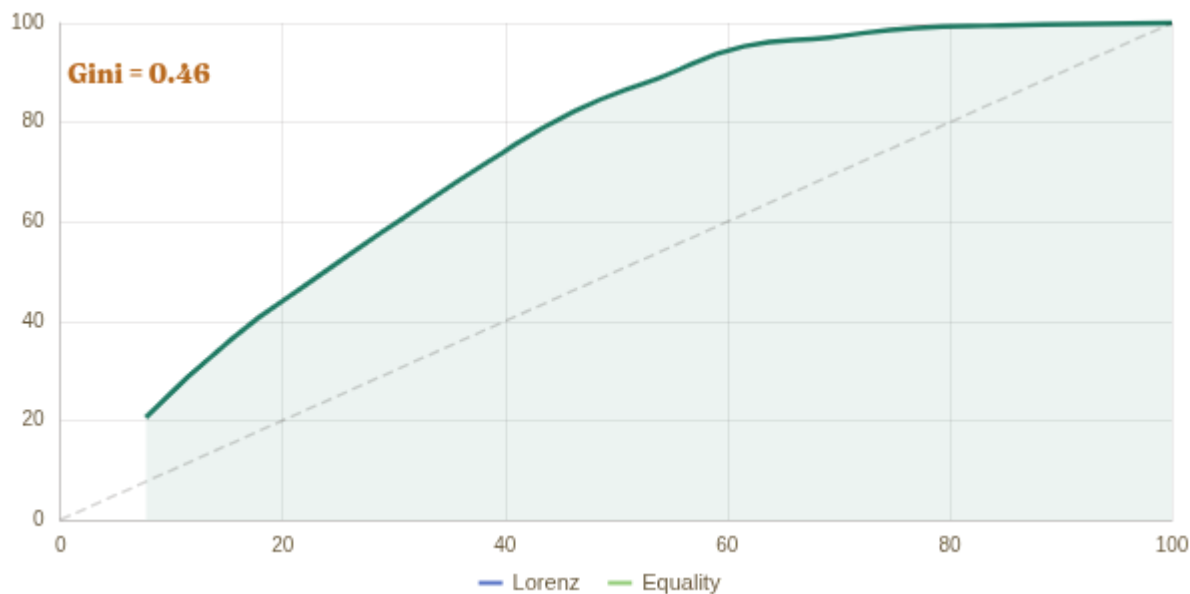
RANK	WILAYA	IPE	OUT OF SCHOOL	RATE	MAHADRA	NO INSTR.	LEVER
1	Guidimakha	92.2	42 852	44.4 %	1 851	41 001	Build schools
2	Hodh El Gharbi	86.7	44 454	47.3 %	30 953	13 501	Pathways to formal schooling
3	Assaba	81.6	46 959	41.5 %	26 559	20 400	Value traditional education
4	Hodh Ech Chargui	78.2	59 348	40.7 %	48 740	10 608	Pathways to formal schooling
5	Gorgol	72.6	37 690	33.5 %	12 041	25 660	Value traditional education
6	Brakna	64.1	23 688	25.5 %	7 629	16 049	Strengthen school retention
7	Trarza	61.4	25 443	31.6 %	19 950	5 493	Value traditional education
8	Nouakchott	59.1	77 296	24.8 %	45 188	32 108	Value traditional education
9	Tagant	56.3	6 927	30.2 %	1 281	5 646	Strengthen school retention
10	Dakhlet Nouadhibou	32.3	7 101	21.2 %	3 438	3 663	Value traditional education
11	Tiris Zemmour	19.3	2 006	16.3 %	643	1 363	Consolidate / monitor
12	Inchiri	16.6	887	16.9 %	651	236	Value traditional education
13	Adrar	10.8	915	6.2 %	569	346	Consolidate / monitor

VISUAL IPE RANKING



03 Territorial concentration

Exclusion is not diffuse: **5 wilayas carry 72,1 %** of out-of-school formal education (top 3: 48.9%), and 4 wilayas are enough to reach half. The Lorenz curve measures this inequality (Gini: 0.46).



TOP 1 Nouakchott

77 296 out-of-school children, i.e.
20.6% of the total.

TOP 5 72.1% of the problem

5 wilayas in the east and south:
Guidimakha, Hodh El Gharbi, Hodh
Ech Chargui, Assaba, Brakna.

TARGET 4 wilayas = 50%

Geographic prioritisation
concentrates effort on a limited
number of territories.

04 Wilaya typology and decomposition of exclusion

Three regional profiles (k-means, k = 3)

PROFILE C0 · 5 WILAYAS

Near-universal schooling

Consolidate and monitor

Adrar · Dakhlet Nouadhibou ·
Inchiri · Nouakchott · Tiris
Zemmour

PROFILE C1 · 4 WILAYAS

Tradition-driven exclusion

Madrassa → formal pathways

Assaba · Hodh Ech Chargui · Hodh
El Gharbi · Trarza

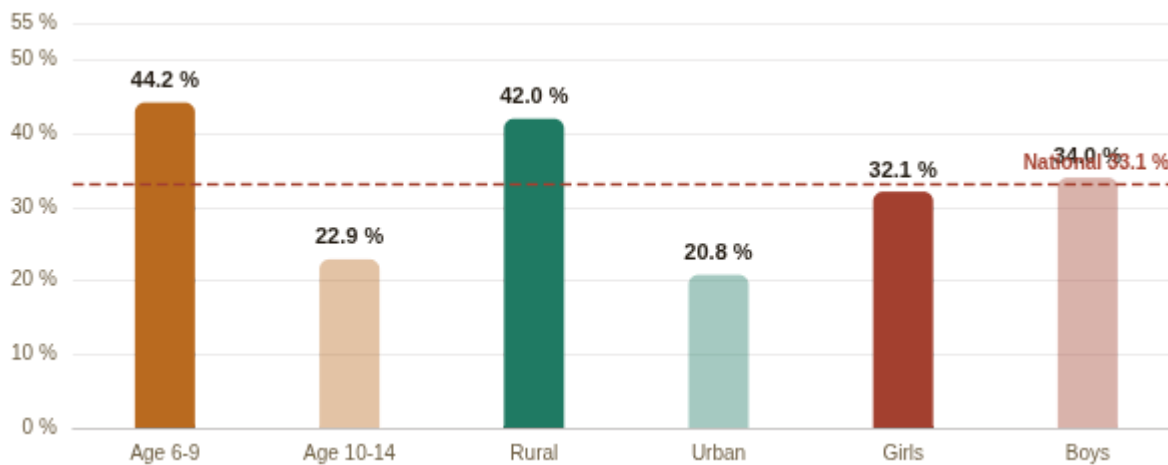
PROFILE C2 · 4 WILAYAS

Exclusion dominated by 'no instruction'

Build schools

Brakna · Gorgol · Guidimakha ·
Tagant

Decomposition of out-of-school formal education



Reading: among those excluded from the formal system, 50.5% are in mahadra and 49.5% have no instruction. Young age and rurality dominate; gender is neutral.

05 Individual determinants: logistic regression (EPCV 2019)

Logistic model on 16 451 children aged 6-14 (Nagelkerke pseudo-R²: 0.12, AIC 18485). The odds ratios (OR) measure over-exposure to the out-of-school risk relative to the reference category.

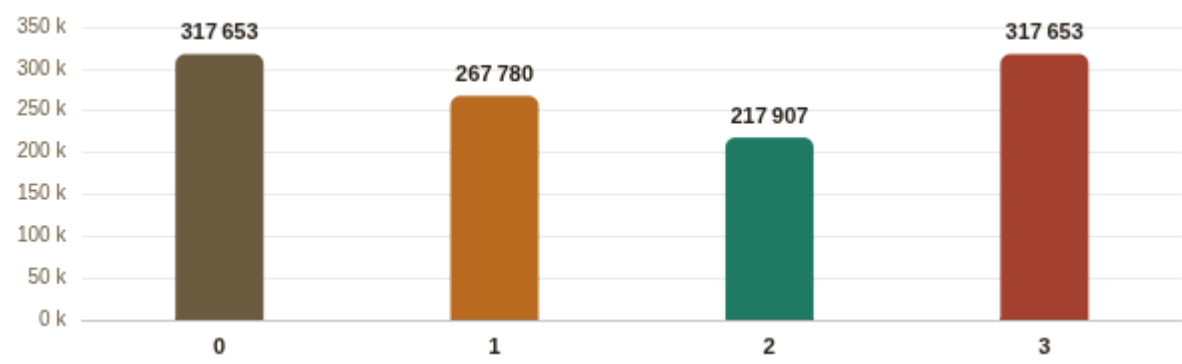
FACTOR	OR	95% CI	P	READING
Âge 6-9 ans (réf. 10-14)	2.82	[2.62 – 3.02]	<0.001	strongly increased risk
Milieu rural (réf. urbain)	2.41	[2.17 – 2.67]	<0.001	strongly increased risk
Ménage pauvre (réf. non pauvre)	1.91	[1.77 – 2.06]	<0.001	strongly increased risk
Sexe féminin	0.91	[0.85 – 0.98]	0.008	marginal effect

Wilaya effects (ref.: Nouakchott)

Hodh El Gharbi OR 1.18 · p 0.055	Assaba OR 0.96 · p 0.628	Hodh Ech Chargui OR 0.92 · p 0.284
Guidimakha OR 0.90 · p 0.191	Dakhlet Nouadhibou OR 0.80 · p 0.045	Gorgol OR 0.71 · p <0.001

06 Scenarios 2030: how many children, at what cost

The global out-of-school primary trend (-0.64 pt/yr) applied to 2022-2030 leaves ~**318 000 children** out of formal school in 2030. The scenarios test policy responses. Assumptions: 6-14 population constant; €1 ≈ 460 MRO; indicative cost of 25 M MRO per school (40 pupils).



BASELINE

Business-as-usual trajectory

Progression observée (-0.64 pt/an, WDI 2008-2024) prolongée jusqu'en 2030.

317 653 children (rate 28.0%)
- 57 913 vs 2022

TARGET 1

Mahadra → formal bridges (25 %)

Convert a quarter of children in traditional education to the formal system by 2030.

267 780 children (rate 23.6%)
- 107 786 vs 2022

TARGET 2

Mahadra → formal bridges (50 %)

Convert half of children in traditional education to the formal system by 2030.

217 907 children (rate 19.2%)
- 157 659 vs 2022

SUPPLY

Building proximity schools

Reach 1 school per 1,000 children in every wilaya (current density: 0.59/1,000 nationally).

317 653 children (rate 28.0%)
- 57 913 vs 2022

Local school construction needs (top wilayas)

WILAYA	RATE 2022	OUT OF SCHOOL	MAHADRA	SCHOOLS / 1,000	SCHOOLS TO BUILD	COST (M MRO)
Hodh Ech Chargui	40.7 %	59 348	48 740	0.14	125	3 125
Gorgol	33.5 %	37 690	12 041	0.20	90	2 250
Assaba	41.5 %	46 959	26 559	0.27	83	2 075
Hodh El Gharbi	47.2 %	44 454	30 953	0.15	80	2 000
Trarza	31.6 %	25 443	19 950	0.15	68	1 700
Brakna	25.5 %	23 688	7 629	0.29	66	1 650

07 Recommendations: four territories, four strategies

Massive effort

256 746 children · 6 wilayas

Many children and a high rate: the double burden. Absolute priority for building and recruitment.

Assaba · Gorgol · Guidimakha · Hodh Ech Chargui · Hodh El Gharbi · Trarza

Targeting enrolments

77 296 children · 1 wilayas

Large pools of children with a moderate rate: the effort focuses on converting enrolments (bridges, retention).

Nouakchott

Consolidation

34 597 children · 5 wilayas

Contained numbers and rates: maintain, monitor flows and prevent any reversal in schooling.

Adrar · Brakna · Dakhlet Nouadhibou · Inchiri · Tiris Zemmour

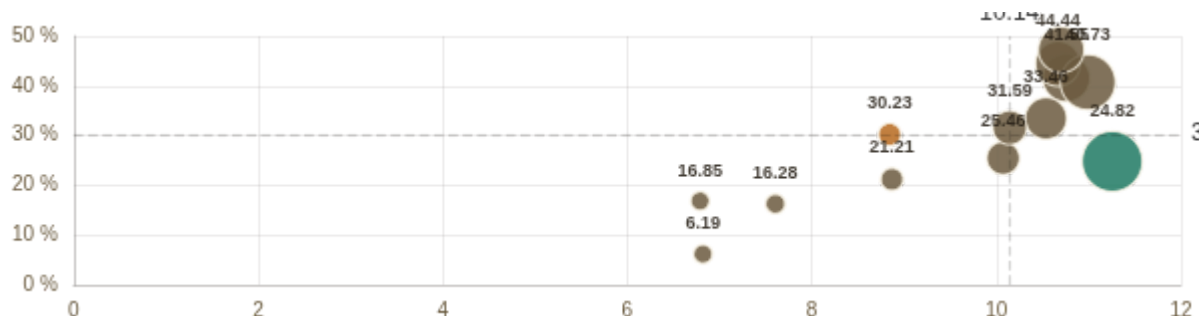
Local response

6 927 children · 1 wilayas

Small numbers but strong exclusion: proximity solutions, integrating mahadra, targeted monitoring of at-risk areas.

Tagant

VOLUME × INTENSITY MATRIX (NATIONAL MEDIANS)



Methodology & sources

EPCV 2019 (ONS) 60,600 individuals, education module (schooling status, age, area, poverty) for the individual models (logit) and the decomposition.

Projections ONS/UNFPA 2022 populations by wilaya (6-14 age structure).

Banque mondiale WDI 2000-2024 series (SE.PRM.UNER.ZS, SE.PRM.NENR, etc.) for the scenario trend.

MLN & OSM number of establishments per wilaya; OpenStreetMap geometries.

Models weighted IPE (volume/intensity/vulnerability), k-means (silhouette, k=3), Pearson correlations, logistic regression (statsmodels), CART decision trees for association rules (support, confidence, lift).

Limitations the EPCV 2019 is the latest available household survey; the 2022 projections distribute the national total; school costs are indicative (25 M MRO).



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PRODUCED BY THE DATASPHERE TEAM

FROM PERCENTAGES TO CHILDREN, FROM CHILDREN TO DECISIONS.

1 AUGUST 2026